subject soon started reflecting in the notes he produced on the basis of open information and inputs from the R&AW stations abroad, some of which might have actually resulted from 1 Akbar Road group-inspired moves. However, those reports were appreciated even at the foreign minister's level. [14] Though none of the senior-level consumers of the reports, including cabinet ministers, had any power to change the course of events predetermined by the 1 Akbar Road group, Raman's reports might have led them to think that events in Punjab required the strongest possible action to save India's unity, thereby providing some justification in their minds about the severity of action taken through Operation Blue Star.

Third, the principal information officer to the prime minster is usually not a recipient of the R&AW reports, for obvious reasons. But from the way Kao sent me to hand over my report to the PIO to the PM, H.Y. Sharda Prasad, in January 1982, it appeared that Kao and Sharada Prasad were working in tandem. It is also obvious that Sharada Prasad used my report as a barometer to measure the impact of his media management on furthering the cause of Op-2. That report might also have been used to assess what more needed to be done. It created a vicious circle, with Raman feeding information to Sharda Prasad, Sharda Prasad feeding that information to his high-level contacts in the Indian press, which information in turn appeared in some leading newspapers in the form of beefed-up lead articles on editorial pages written by influential journalists, and finally that information in the form of press clippings landing on Raman's table to confirm what he originally thought to be reliable and worth sharing with the consumers of information.

Fourth, while transcribing secretly recorded conversations of meetings of Akali leaders with senior Congress leaders, and of 'Khalistani elements' and influential Sikhs with Kao in London, Zurich and elsewhere, Raman was influenced by the views of Rajiv Gandhi and his friends in the first instance and by Kao's later, for reasons explained earlier. It is extremely difficult for most civil servants to not be influenced by the views of important people around them. Besides, in such an environment there is little scope